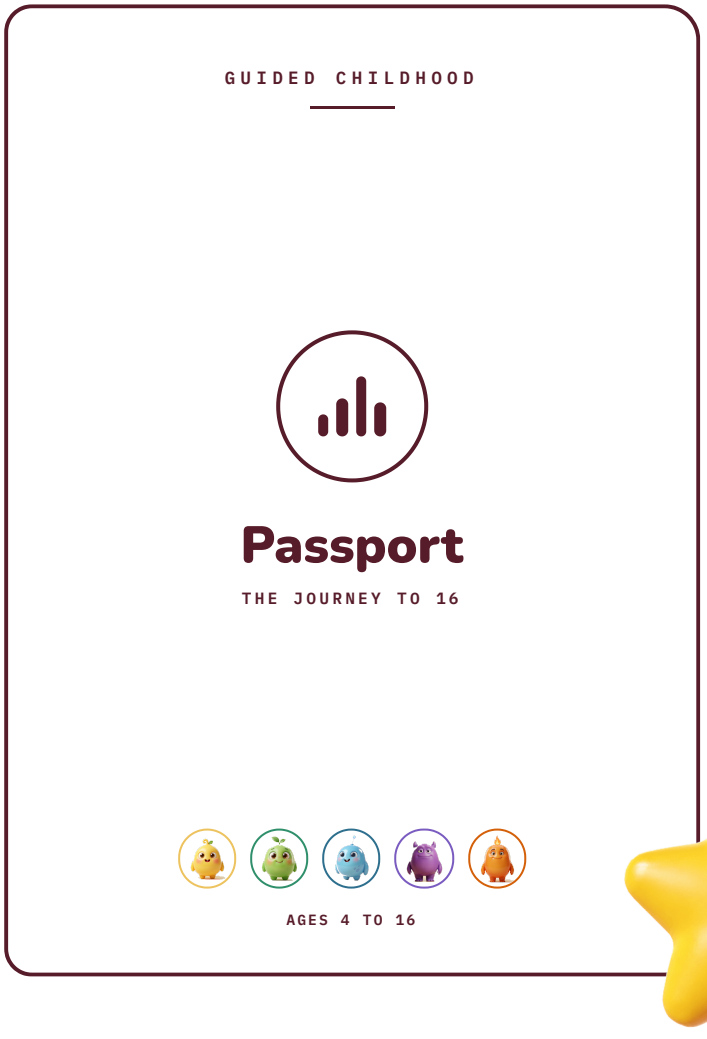
PRINT, FOLD, STAMP · AGES 4 TO 16

# The Guided Childhood Passport

One page for every stage, from four to sixteen.
Every stamp is earned at the kitchen table.




- Fold out passport
- Five stage pages and guides
- Stamp and sticker sheet
- What earns each stamp
- Phone version included

TWO MINUTES BEFORE YOU START

# How the Passport works

Five pages, one for every stage from four to sixteen. Each page belongs to a Planet Friend and carries one conversation, one thing to do, and one check. When all three are done, the page gets its stamp. So a stamp is earned rather than a birthday reached.

Join at any age. Start on the page your child is on now. The earlier pages stay open, so you can go back and catch them up whenever you like. Nothing on it runs out.



**Pebble**
4 TO 7

**Bloop**
8 TO 10

**Orbit**
11 TO 12

**Nova**
13 TO 15

**Cosmo**
16 AND UP

### MAKE THE FOLD OUT PASSPORT

One sheet, one slit, three folds, and it is a passport the size of a real one.

1. Fold the sheet in half the long way, so the top row meets the bottom row, and open it again.
2. Fold it in half the short way, then fold each end back to the middle. You now have eight rectangles.
3. Fold it in half the short way again. Cut along the middle crease from the folded edge as far as the first crease, and no further.
4. Open it out, fold it the long way again, and push the two ends towards each other. The middle opens up. Fold it closed with the cover on the outside.

### PRINT SETTINGS

Print the fold out page landscape at actual size. Turn fit to page off, because scaling moves the creases. Tick background graphics, or the burgundy cover comes out white.

### STAMPS AND STICKERS

Print the stamp sheet on sticker paper, or on plain paper with a glue stick. Big stamps go on the big pages, small ones in the fold out book.

THE JOURNEY TO 16

# Guided Childhood Passport

NAME

STICKERS EARNED SO FAR

The talks, the doings and the checks, one page at a time. Keep this book somewhere safe. It is the record of the journey to 16.

GUIDEDCHILDHOOD.COM

STAGE 4 · 13 TO 15

## Nova

SHAPER



STAMP HERE

Identity formation and digital footprint while the relationship still holds

STICK YOUR STICKER HERE

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

TALK DO CHECK

4 OF 5

STAGE 5 · 16 AND UP

## Cosmo

INDEPENDENT



STAMP HERE

Building genuine digital independence before they leave home

STICK YOUR STICKER HERE

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

TALK DO CHECK

5 OF 5

CUT HERE ONLY

STAGE 1 · 4 TO 7

## Pebble

FOUNDATION



STAMP HERE

First relationships with technology, before habits form

STICK YOUR STICKER HERE

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

TALK DO CHECK

1 OF 5

STAGE 2 · 8 TO 10

## Bloop

BUILDER



STAMP HERE

Building digital habits before the algorithm learns them

STICK YOUR STICKER HERE

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

TALK DO CHECK

2 OF 5

STAGE 3 · 11 TO 12

## Orbit

EXPLORER



STAMP HERE

The algorithm conversation before social media

STICK YOUR STICKER HERE

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

TALK DO CHECK

3 OF 5

THIS PASSPORT BELONGS TO

Five pages, one for every stage from four to sixteen. A page stamps when its talk, its doing and its check are done, so a stamp is earned rather than a birthday reached.

Colour a page in when it stamps, or stick its sticker on.

WHAT EVERY PAGE BUILDS

- Safe online
- Healthy balance
- AI literate
- Social ready

OF 5 STAMPED

STAGE 1 · FOUNDATION · AGES 4 TO 7

# Pebble's page



"Full of curiosity and wonder. Every big journey starts small."

THIS STAGE: FIRST RELATIONSHIPS WITH TECHNOLOGY, BEFORE HABITS FORM

STAMP HERE

DATE STAMPED

SIGNED BY

AND BY

THREE THINGS STAMP THIS PAGE

1 · THE TALK

**The First Device Conversation**

Say this: "We have a family rule about screens. When the timer goes off, screens go down. Every time, no exceptions. And then we do something together."

2 · THE DOING

**Set up a charging station in the kitchen or hallway tonight. Devices do not sleep in bedrooms in this house.**

3 · THE CHECK

**Your child can tell you, in their own words: why the screen goes down when the timer goes, and what you do together next.**

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

GO FURTHER ON THIS PAGE

Packs in the Guided Childhood shop on Etsy. Tick when done, then add its sticker.

- TALK Say This
- TALK The Calm Down Corner Kit
- DOING Earn Your Screen Time
- TALK Screens at Granny's
- DOING The Star Swap Shop
- DOING The Christmas Screen Free Countdown
- DOING Are We Nearly There
- DOING Where Phones Sleep

STAGE 1 · THE GUIDE · AGES 4 TO 7

# Pebble’s guide



The rest of this stage on one page: what to say when it happens, what to try with your own phone, and what is worth a closer look.

USUALLY AT THIS AGE · YEAR 1 TO 3

**Shared family device with full supervision**

NOT THIS

"Just five more minutes." Once you move the line, it moves every time.

YOUR OWN PHONE **When the timer ends their screen time, put your own phone away too. The rule is for the house, not just for them.**

## WHEN IT HAPPENS

### When screens take over

Set a visual timer and agree together when screens stop. The timer is the rule, not you.

### When the mood dips after

Try ten minutes of wind down between screens and the next activity. At this age, mood is often about the transition, not the screen itself.

### When it is a game

Play with them for 10 minutes. Understand the game before you set any limits on it.

### Staying safe online

At this age, online safety means one thing: same room, same screen. No unsupervised time.

### Starting a conversation

Try tonight: "What do you like best about that show?" Then listen for two full minutes before saying anything.

### When they ask for a phone

The answer is not yet, it is "here is what we will build first." Talk about what a device earns, not what age unlocks it.

## WORTH A CLOSER LOOK

- Tantrums or real distress when a device is taken away
- Choosing screens over play every time they have a choice
- No longer interested in activities they loved before devices

One of these on its own is common. If something worries you, talk to your child’s school or your GP.

Every line on this page comes from the Guided Childhood app, which also has this stage’s lessons, every script and the stage check.

STAGE 2 · BUILDER · AGES 8 TO 10

# Bloop's page



"Creative and clever. Building skills and strong foundations."

THIS STAGE: BUILDING DIGITAL HABITS BEFORE THE ALGORITHM LEARNS THEM

STAMP HERE

DATE STAMPED

SIGNED BY

AND BY

THREE THINGS STAMP THIS PAGE

1 · THE TALK

**The Bedroom Rule**

Say this: "Where does your phone sleep at night? In our house, phones sleep in the kitchen. The bedroom is for sleep."

2 · THE DOING

**Have the bedroom rule conversation tonight as a family decision, not a rule you impose. Where should our devices sleep?**

3 · THE CHECK

**Your child can tell you, in their own words: where devices sleep at night in your house, and why.**

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

GO FURTHER ON THIS PAGE

Packs in the Guided Childhood shop on Etsy. Tick when done, then add its sticker.

- TALK Say This
- TALK The Family Phone Agreement
- DOING Earn Your Screen Time
- TALK Screens at Granny's
- DOING The Star Swap Shop
- DOING The Holiday Screen Deal
- DOING The Christmas Screen Free Countdown
- DOING Are We Nearly There
- DOING Where Phones Sleep
- CHECK The 30 Day Screen Reset Journal

STAGE 2 · THE GUIDE · AGES 8 TO 10

# Bloop’s guide



The rest of this stage on one page: what to say when it happens, what to try with your own phone, and what is worth a closer look.

USUALLY AT THIS AGE · YEAR 3 TO 6

**Shared device moving toward a supervised personal device**

NOT THIS

"You need to earn the right to have it in your room." That makes it a prize, not a family norm.

YOUR OWN PHONE **Charge your own phone in the kitchen overnight, next to theirs. One rule for everyone is the easiest rule to keep.**

## WHEN IT HAPPENS

### When screens take over

Agree on two places in your home where screens never go: mealtimes and bedrooms. Agreed once, kept every day, no exceptions.

### When the mood dips after

Note mood before and after screen time for one week. Then share what you notice as an observation, not a conclusion.

### When it is a game

Ask them to teach you their favourite game. Play together for 10 minutes. Understanding before limits.

### Staying safe online

The key conversation now: "You can always come to me if something online feels weird or wrong. I will not take the device away. I will help."

### Starting a conversation

Try this: "What is the best thing you have seen online this week?" Then: "Has anything online ever made you feel bad about yourself?"

### When they ask for a phone

A feature phone, calls and texts with no apps, is a good first device at this stage. Independence without the algorithm.

## WORTH A CLOSER LOOK

- Using devices secretly or hiding what they watch
- Starting to compare themselves to what they see online
- Mood changes around device removal that feel out of proportion

One of these on its own is common. If something worries you, talk to your child’s school or your GP.

Every line on this page comes from the Guided Childhood app, which also has this stage’s lessons, every script and the stage check.

STAGE 3 · EXPLORER · AGES 11 TO 12

# Orbit's page



"Exploring bigger worlds and asking big questions."

THIS STAGE: THE ALGORITHM CONVERSATION BEFORE SOCIAL MEDIA

STAMP HERE

DATE STAMPED

SIGNED BY

AND BY

THREE THINGS STAMP THIS PAGE

1 · THE TALK

## The Algorithm Conversation

Say this: "Did you know your phone is learning what you like? Every video you watch, every post you pause on, it notes it. Open your feed and we will look at it together."

2 · THE DOING

**Open their feed together tonight. No judgement, just curiosity: why do you think it showed you that? Stay for ten minutes.**

3 · THE CHECK

**Your child can tell you, in their own words: how the feed learns what they like, and why a confident answer still needs checking.**

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

GO FURTHER ON THIS PAGE

Packs in the Guided Childhood shop on Etsy. Tick when done, then add its sticker.

- TALK Say This
- TALK The Family Phone Agreement
- TALK The First Phone Kit
- DOING The Holiday Screen Deal
- CHECK The 30 Day Screen Reset Journal

STAGE 3 · THE GUIDE · AGES 11 TO 12

# Orbit’s guide



The rest of this stage on one page: what to say when it happens, what to try with your own phone, and what is worth a closer look.

USUALLY AT THIS AGE · YEAR 7 TO 8

**First personal device, a feature phone strongly recommended over a smartphone**

NOT THIS

"That app is rotting your brain." That shuts the conversation down before it starts.

YOUR OWN PHONE **Say it out loud when you stop scrolling: "I have been on that too long, I am putting it down." Let them see you stop, not just hear you ask them to.**

## WHEN IT HAPPENS

### When screens take over

The bedroom rule is the place to start. If it is not in place yet, start there tonight.

### When the mood dips after

Sit together and scroll their feed for 10 minutes. Ask what they feel, not what they think: "Does any of this make you feel good about yourself?"

### When it is a game

Ask what they love about the game. The community, the challenge, the escape? Understanding what it gives them tells you what need it is meeting.

### Staying safe online

Say this clearly: "If anyone online ever makes you uncomfortable, or asks you to keep something secret, you tell me immediately. I will help first and ask questions later."

### Starting a conversation

Try tonight: "I have been reading about how algorithms work. Can I show you something? I think it is actually kind of fascinating."

### When they ask for a phone

Before social media comes a conversation about how the algorithm works. Their response to that conversation is what readiness looks like.

## WORTH A CLOSER LOOK

- Mood drops noticeably after phone use
- Anxiety about being left out of what is happening online
- Sleep disruption, checking the phone after lights out
- Withdrawal from family conversations

One of these on its own is common. If something worries you, talk to your child’s school or your GP.

Every line on this page comes from the Guided Childhood app, which also has this stage’s lessons, every script and the stage check.

STAGE 4 · SHAPER · AGES 13 TO 15

# Nova's page



"Learning to make good choices and shape your path."

THIS STAGE: IDENTITY FORMATION AND DIGITAL FOOTPRINT WHILE THE RELATIONSHIP STILL HOLDS

STAMP HERE

DATE STAMPED

SIGNED BY

AND BY

THREE THINGS STAMP THIS PAGE

1 · THE TALK

**When Things Go Wrong Online**

Say this: "If anything ever goes wrong online, and things do go wrong, I am the first call you make, not the last. I will not overreact. I will help."

2 · THE DOING

**Set up a weekly ten minutes with no agenda. Not about screens, not about homework. Same day, same time, just checking in.**

3 · THE CHECK

**Your child can tell you, in their own words: who their first call is if something goes wrong online, and that telling you will not cost them their phone.**

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

GO FURTHER ON THIS PAGE

Packs in the Guided Childhood shop on Etsy. Tick when done, then add its sticker.

TALK **Say This** | DOING **The First Phone Kit** | CHECK **The 30 Day Screen Reset Journal**

STAGE 4 · THE GUIDE · AGES 13 TO 15

# Nova’s guide



The rest of this stage on one page: what to say when it happens, what to try with your own phone, and what is worth a closer look.

USUALLY AT THIS AGE · YEAR 9 TO 10

**Smartphone with agreed family guidelines in place**

NOT THIS

"If I catch you doing that, I am taking your phone." That closes the door before anything happens.

YOUR OWN PHONE **Give them the right to call you out when you are on your phone at the table. It is the same right you are asking for.**

## WHEN IT HAPPENS

### When screens take over

Shift the frame from time to what it does for them, and start with the good: "What are the best bits of your phone at the moment?" Listen properly.

### When the mood dips after

Try: "I have noticed your mood sometimes changes after being on your phone. Have you noticed that?" Leave space for silence. Do not fill it.

### When it is a game

Ask about the people they play with online. Gaming at this age is usually social. The game is the venue, not the point.

### Staying safe online

Make sure the open door is open: "If anything ever makes you uncomfortable online, I am the first call, not the last. I will not take your phone away. I will help."

### Starting a conversation

Ask about one thing they have been into online this week. Not a test, genuine curiosity. Then ask one more question.

### Family phone rules

If guidelines are still the conversation: agreed as a family, not imposed by you.

## WORTH A CLOSER LOOK

- Secretive phone use or panic if you pick up the device
- Extreme mood swings tied to online interactions
- Online relationships that feel more real than offline ones
- Withdrawal from activities they previously enjoyed

One of these on its own is common. If something worries you, talk to your child’s school or your GP.

Every line on this page comes from the Guided Childhood app, which also has this stage’s lessons, every script and the stage check.

STAGE 5 · INDEPENDENT · AGES 16 AND UP

# Cosmo's page



"Confident and independent. Ready to lead your own future."

THIS STAGE: BUILDING GENUINE DIGITAL INDEPENDENCE BEFORE THEY LEAVE HOME

STAMP HERE

DATE STAMPED

SIGNED BY

AND BY

THREE THINGS STAMP THIS PAGE

1 · THE TALK

**Building Independence**

Say this: "You are at the age where you get to decide what kind of digital life you build. What does your online presence say about who you are? Not to me. To the world."

2 · THE DOING

**A joint digital audit: go through their online presence together as peers. What does it say? What would they change?**

3 · THE CHECK

**Your child can tell you, in their own words: what their phone gives them and what it costs them.**

THE BEST THING I LEARNED

GO FURTHER ON THIS PAGE

Packs in the Guided Childhood shop on Etsy. Tick when done, then add its sticker.

TALK Say This

CHECK The 30 Day Screen Reset Journal

STAGE 5 · THE GUIDE · AGES 16 AND UP

# Cosmo's guide



The rest of this stage on one page: what to say when it happens, what to try with your own phone, and what is worth a closer look.

USUALLY AT THIS AGE · YEAR 11 AND ABOVE

**Full smartphone, the conversation has shifted to digital literacy**

NOT THIS

"Get off your phone." That conversation is over. A different one has started.

YOUR OWN PHONE **Be honest about your own phone: what it gives you, and what it costs you. It is the conversation you are hoping they will have with themselves.**

## WHEN IT HAPPENS

### When screens take over

Start with what they enjoy: "What are the best things you get from your phone?" Then your side, as a worry rather than a verdict: "I worry it has become a habit. What do you think?"

### When the mood dips after

Try: "I have noticed you seem different after being on your phone. How does it leave you feeling?" Then ask about the rest of their week, school and friends.

### When it is a game

At 16, gaming can be a career interest, a creative outlet or a core social life. Engage with it seriously. Ask what they get from it.

### Staying safe online

Sextortion, deepfakes and AI generated content are real at this age. Have a specific, calm conversation about what to do if anything goes wrong.

### Starting a conversation

Ask them to show you one thing online they think you should know about. Then listen without judgement for five minutes.

### Growing independence

The conversation is about upgrading the relationship, not unlocking a device. What does responsible independence look like for someone nearly an adult?

## WORTH A CLOSER LOOK

- Measuring their worth through likes, followers or metrics
- Struggling to be fully present in real life situations
- Significant anxiety when without phone access
- No meaningful offline friendships or activities

One of these on its own is common. If something worries you, talk to your child's school or your GP.

Every line on this page comes from the Guided Childhood app, which also has this stage's lessons, every script and the stage check.

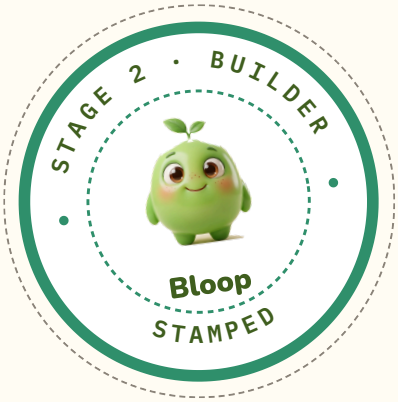
CUT OUT, PEEL AND STICK

# Stamps and stickers

The big stamps go in the ring on each stage page. The small ones fit the fold out passport. Use them only when all three things on a page are done, so every stamp means something.

## BIG STAMPS FOR THE STAGE PAGES
















## SMALL STAMPS FOR THE FOLD OUT PASSPORT




## DIGI STARS, FOR A GOOD TRY ON THE WAY



FOR THE GROWN UPS

# What earns each stamp

A page stamps when all three are done: you have had the talk, you have done the one thing, and your child can tell you the big idea back in their own words. The check is a chat, never a test. If it does not land yet, try again another day.

| | THE TALK | THE DOING | THE CHECK |
|---|---|---|---|
|  **Pebble** 4 TO 7 | The First Device Conversation | A charging station out of the bedrooms | Timer goes, screen down, then something together |
|  **Bloop** 8 TO 10 | The Bedroom Rule | Decide together where devices sleep | Where devices sleep, and why |
|  **Orbit** 11 TO 12 | The Algorithm Conversation | Ten curious minutes in their feed | How the feed learns, and checking what sounds sure |
|  **Nova** 13 TO 15 | When Things Go Wrong Online | A weekly ten minutes, no agenda | Who the first call is when it goes wrong |
|  **Cosmo** 16 AND UP | Building Independence | A digital audit together, as peers | What their phone gives, and what it costs |

### JOINING LATER THAN FOUR?

Start on the page for your child's age today. Catching up an earlier page is its talk and its check. The habits are kept up on the page they are on now, never asked for twice.

### CATCH UP, CLAIM THE REWARD

When every page up to your child's age is stamped, the Road to 16 guide is yours free: the balance, the behaviour to watch, each platform and the age it usually turns up, and the school pressure points along the way. Claim it at guidedchildhood.com/etsy-bonus.

### FOR THE FULL EFFECT, THE APP

The Guided Childhood app runs this same Passport for you. Each stage comes with its lessons, every script and a short stage check, and the stamps land on their own. The paper one and the app one are the same book, so you can start here and carry on there.

A FREE GIFT FOR YOUR FAMILY

# Thank you for starting the journey to 16



As a thank you, the full Guided Childhood Starter Pack is yours free: the star chart, the jobs that earn the stars, and a whole booklet of things to do away from a screen. Pop your email in at the address below and it is yours.

**guidedchildhood.com/etsy-bonus**

Made by Justin at Guided Childhood, a dad who got tired of the screen time fight. If the Passport earns a place on your fridge, a kind review on Etsy helps another family find it.